THE AI PARROTS

Volume 2 | AI in everyday life

For curious teachers and cautious beginners

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School, health, shopping, and the apps we use



AI-created illustration of an everyday situation; not a photograph or a product screen.

Dear colleagues,

You may meet artificial intelligence (AI) while planning a lesson, visiting your doctor, shopping for supplies, or using an app. You do not need to understand computer science to ask a useful question: What is this helping someone do, and what still needs checking?

In Volume 2, we keep our education spotlight and add healthcare, retail shopping, and software development, the work of building apps and computer programs. Our examples include Indiana schools and Reid Health in Richmond, Indiana.

Four updates to know

Education | October 27: MagicSchool adds images inside documents and hours when student learning spaces close (Ronquillo, 2026).

Healthcare | October 27: Abridge adds ways to rewrite take-home visit summaries in simpler language (Abridge, 2026).

Retail | October 30: Walmart expands Sparky, including turning a photo of a shopping list into a suggested cart (Walmart, 2026).

Technology | October 28: GitHub Copilot adds a deeper software review option and broader access to AI approval of proposed changes (GitHub, 2026).

Our promise: Plain language, relatable examples, and clear sources. This issue covers updates from October 7-November 7, 2026. Older cases provide background. Imagined examples are labeled. Company reports are not treated as independent proof.

SCHOOL SPOTLIGHT | INDIANA

Who opens the AI classroom door?



The teacher chooses.
The teacher checks.
The teacher decides.

Conceptual AI-generated illustration; not a product screenshot or a photograph of the case.

The real story

At Indiana's Mt. Vernon Community School Corporation, teachers create Student Rooms, MagicSchool's online spaces for specific learning activities. They select the tools students can use, watch their activity, and close the space afterward. The district prepared through a teacher learning group and staff training (Mt. Vernon Community School Corporation, n.d.).

What changed this month

MagicSchool's October 27 update adds image creation directly inside documents, more options for how documents look, and set hours when Student Rooms close across the district. These are the online learning spaces described above (Ronquillo, 2026).

The work: Teachers can prepare illustrated materials in one place. School leaders can set the same opening and closing hours across schools. **The choice:** Staff must decide which illustrations help learning and when student access serves a clear purpose.

Picture it in a science lesson

Imagine this: A teacher drafts a water-cycle worksheet and adds an image in the same document. Before sharing it, the teacher checks the labels, arrows, and questions against the lesson goal. The convenience is real; the scientific accuracy still needs review.

What could help and what needs checking

Teachers may switch between fewer tools, and schools can use the same access rules. Those features alone do not establish improved learning or time savings. A small school trial could compare total preparation and checking time, record corrections, and ask students to explain the concept afterward.

Future value depends on accurate materials, images all students can understand, useful training, and clear school rules. MagicSchool itself says teachers must check what it produces (MagicSchool, n.d.).

For your next team meeting: What would make an AI-prepared resource good enough for your students?

HEALTHCARE SPOTLIGHT | RICHMOND INDIANA

Can the doctor listen more and type less?



Less time typing.
More time listening.
Still checked by people.

AI-created illustration of an everyday situation; not a photograph or a product screen.

The real story

Reid Health in Indiana chose Abridge to help prepare written records of patient visits. The tool uses recorded conversations to draft notes for care teams. Abridge's customer case reports less after-hours paperwork and faster responses to patient calls (Abridge, n.d.). These are company-reported results from an earlier case, not findings about this month's update.

What changed this month

On October 27, Abridge announced ways to adjust the take-home summary of a visit. A doctor or other care professional can ask the tool to replace medical terms with everyday words, change the reading level, or address the summary to a parent. These changes affect the patient's summary, not the medical note (Abridge, 2026). We have not confirmed whether Reid Health uses this new feature.

What changes in daily work

The work: Care teams can start with a prepared note and adapt written instructions instead of writing everything from scratch. **The choice:** The professional must check that the record is accurate and that simpler wording preserves the intended meaning. The tool supports paperwork; it does not take responsibility for care.

Imagine this

A parent leaves an appointment with a long summary full of unfamiliar words. The doctor uses AI to prepare a shorter explanation, checks it, and asks the parent to explain the next steps in their own words. This is an imagined example of how the new feature could be used.

Why this matters to educators

Teachers know that giving someone information does not mean they understood it. The same is true at a medical visit. The future opportunity is clearer communication and less paperwork, but the useful test is whether people understand the checked instructions, not whether the tool produces more text.

Talk with your team: When we simplify a message for families, how do we make sure we have kept its meaning?

RETAIL SPOTLIGHT | A UNITED STATES EXAMPLE

From a handwritten list to a shopping cart



A quicker shopping list.
A closer look
before checkout.

AI-created illustration of an everyday situation; not a photograph or a product screen.

The real product example

Walmart's Sparky is an AI shopping assistant that helps customers find products. In its October 30 announcement, Walmart demonstrated turning a photographed handwritten list into a suggested shopping cart. It also showed product suggestions based on an uploaded picture. These are company demonstrations, not an independent study of shoppers' results (Walmart, 2026).

What changed this month

The update expands picture-based help and list-to-cart shopping for United States customers. Walmart also describes help with recipes and gift ideas. Its announcement says voice features are expected across the chain by year-end, so readers should not assume every feature is already available everywhere (Walmart, 2026).

What changes in daily work

The work: A shopper can describe a task or upload a list instead of searching for each item separately. For the retailer, that puts product selection closer to checkout. **The choice:** The shopper still decides whether suggested products fit the budget and purpose. A convenient suggestion is not proof of the best deal.

Imagine an Indiana teacher shopping

A teacher in Indianapolis needs cups, string, tape, and craft sticks for a class project. They photograph the list and review the suggested cart. Did the assistant select enough supplies for 30 students? Are the pack sizes right? Is an expensive version unnecessary? This is an imagined example, not a reported local trial.

A classroom connection

Give students a fictional project budget and two sample shopping carts. Ask them to compare unit prices, quantities, and leftover supplies. They can explain which cart better meets the need. The same checking skills apply whether a person or an AI assistant chose the items.

Future value depends on accurate matches and clear prices. Check wrong items, total spending, and time saved after reviewing the cart.

Ask your students: What would you check before accepting a shopping recommendation?

TECHNOLOGY SPOTLIGHT | A UNITED STATES CASE

Who checks the app before we use it?



Help with the code. People still test what it does.

AI-created illustration of an everyday situation; not a photograph or a product screen.

The real story

You may know Duolingo as a language-learning app. Behind its lessons are people who build and maintain the software. GitHub's customer story describes Duolingo using GitHub Copilot to suggest computer instructions while developers work. The story reports faster development, but it is a supplier-published case rather than an independent test (GitHub, n.d.).

What changed this month

On October 28, GitHub announced a more thorough Copilot review option called Max, available for users to try while it is still being tested. It also made AI approval of proposed software changes more widely available on eligible paid plans. Approval is off unless administrators enable it (GitHub, 2026). We have not verified Duolingo's use of these new features.

What changes in daily work

The work: AI can suggest software instructions and review changes before a team adds them to an app. **The choice:** Team leaders decide which changes need a person's approval and whether the extra review time and cost are worthwhile. An AI approval is not a guarantee that an app works correctly or protects information.

Imagine a school app update

A team changes a club sign-up form. AI review flags that it may accept entries without names. A developer checks, fixes, and tests the form, including duplicate submissions. This is an imagined example, not a Duolingo incident.

Make it relatable in class

Compare AI review with a classmate checking your instructions for a science activity. A reviewer may notice missing steps, but someone still needs to try the activity. Software needs that practical testing too.

The future opportunity is catching mistakes earlier. Teams should check missed errors and problems introduced by suggested fixes, alongside time saved.

Discussion starter: What evidence would convince you that a new school app feature works as intended?

OUR REGULAR CLOSING FEATURE

Four fields and one useful habit

Across schools, healthcare, shopping, and software, AI is changing who prepares the first version of something. It can help draft materials, simplify a summary, select items, or check computer instructions. People still need to connect that work to the real situation.

Ask what changed after checking

A faster first draft is only part of the story. Did the lesson help students explain an idea? Did the family understand the visit summary? Did the cart contain the right supplies? Did the app work when someone tested it? These are practical ways to judge usefulness.

Ideas in progress | iMATE: Team member Emmanuel Babalola is developing a tutor that gives small hints as students work through difficult problems. MagicSchool already offers teacher-managed student tools. A useful test for iMATE is whether students can explain their reasoning and solve a new problem with less help. This is a developing project, not a new commercial release.

Sources and further reading

Abridge. (2026, October 27). Now in practice: October 2026. Read source

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Editorial note: Sources were checked November 7, 2026. The education article is retained from Volume 1 as requested. AI assisted with research, drafting, design, and illustrations. Real cases and imagined examples are labeled. The team remains responsible for the submission.

Meet the AI Parrots team



Team photograph provided by the contributors.

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